

MASCO101 · MASTERS LEVEL 7 · AY 2026/27

Framework Sheet Library

Tools for Success · 5 ECTS · Term 1 · FHEQ Level 7
Your Human Edge in an AI World

8

UNITS

16

SLIBRARIES

80

REFERENCE SHEETS

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Applying JD Meier's **Thumbnail Thinking** (2025) and Kurt Bostelaar's core-message method.

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Introduction to Tools for Success & Digital/AI Literacy

Guided Discovery · 2 Slibraries · 10 reference sheets

CORE MESSAGE

Your value at work is no longer what you can execute — it is what you can judge, and judgment has to be built on purpose.

Learning focus Foundations & digital fluency · ILO 1

ILO 1 — Systematically select key concepts and principles of operations and technology management that need to be implemented to support value creation.

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Know Yourself: Self-Assessment as a Strategic Tool

Self-Diagnostic Workshop · 2 Slibraries · 10 reference sheets

CORE MESSAGE

You cannot position what you have not diagnosed — self-knowledge is the one input no model can generate for you.

Learning focus Self-assessment & personal positioning · ILO 1

ILO 1 — Systematically select key concepts and principles of operations and technology management that need to be implemented to support value creation.

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Think Better: Critical Thinking & Analytical Reasoning

Head-to-Head Analysis Lab · 2 Slibraries · 10 reference sheets

CORE MESSAGE

AI accelerates answers; only structured thinking decides whether the answer was the right one to look for.

Learning focus Critical thinking & structured problem-solving · ILO 1

ILO 1 — Systematically select key concepts and principles of operations and technology management that need to be implemented to support value creation.

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Present & Position Yourself: Personal Branding & Presentation Skills

Pitch Arena · 2 Slibraries · 10 reference sheets

CORE MESSAGE

A personal brand is not what you claim about yourself; it is the one sentence other people can repeat when you are not in the room.

Learning focus Personal branding & persuasive delivery · **ILO 5**

ILO 5 — Critically review the communication process, stakeholder communication and communication in diverse work groups.

● Slibrary 7 — Personal Brand & Positioning pp. 41–45

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p. 45	Personal Value Proposition Canvas Match their jobs, pains and gains to your offer	Osterwalder et al.

● Slibrary 8 — Pitch & Delivery pp. 46–50

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Communicate with Impact: Executive Presence & Business Communication

Message Clinic · 2 Slibraries · 10 reference sheets

CORE MESSAGE

Executives do not read to discover your conclusion — put it first, then make every sentence after it earn its place.

Learning focus Business communication & executive presence · **ILO 5**

ILO 5 — Critically review the communication process, stakeholder communication and communication in diverse work groups.

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● Slibrary 10 — Audience & Culture pp. 56–60

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p. 59	High- and Low-Context Communication Meaning carried by context, or by the words alone	Edward T. Hall
p. 60	Power–Interest Grid Power against interest sets communication effort	Aubrey L. Mendelow

Deliver Results: Project Management Fundamentals

Project Simulation · 2 Slibraries · 10 reference sheets

CORE MESSAGE

A plan is not a schedule — it is an argument about scope, risk and trade-offs that has to survive contact with reality.

Learning focus Project planning, scheduling & risk · ILO 2 & 3

ILO 2 — Critically assess the roles and responsibilities of a project manager as part of an organisation's strategy.

ILO 3 — Investigate how to select, develop, plan, schedule and measure project outcomes and risks.

● Slibrary 11 — Project Lifecycle & Planning pp. 61–65

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p. 63	Work Breakdown Structure Scope decomposed into ownable work packages	Project Management Institute
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● Slibrary 12 — Agile, Risk & Control pp. 66–70

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p. 70	Earned Value S-Curve Planned, earned and actual plotted against time	Project Management Institute

Negotiate & Influence: Getting What You Need Without Formal Authority

Negotiation Simulation · 2 Slibraries · 10 reference sheets

CORE MESSAGE

Leverage is prepared, not improvised — know your walk-away before you walk in.

Learning focus Negotiation, influence & ethical boundaries · **ILO 4**

ILO 4 — Evaluate the keys to successful negotiation and differentiate negotiation styles, strategies, and tactics.

● Slibrary 13 — Negotiation Architecture pp. 71–75

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p. 72	Zone of Possible Agreement The overlap where a deal beats no deal for both	Howard Raiffa
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● Slibrary 14 — Influence Without Authority pp. 76–80

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Work Smarter with AI: Productivity, Tools and Professional Judgment

Mini-Hackathon · Capstone · 2 Slibraries · 10 reference sheets

CORE MESSAGE

Delegate the task, never the judgment — and be able to show exactly where you drew the line.

Learning focus Productivity systems & AI workflow judgment · ILO 1 & 3

ILO 1 — Systematically select key concepts and principles of operations and technology management that need to be implemented to support value creation.

ILO 3 — Investigate how to select, develop, plan, schedule and measure project outcomes and risks.

● Slibrary 15 — Prioritisation & Energy pp. 81–85

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p. 83	The Rule of 3 Three wins for today, the week, the month, the year	J.D. Meier
p. 84	Monday Vision, Daily Wins, Friday Reflection Plan Monday, win daily, reflect Friday	J.D. Meier
p. 85	Pareto 80/20 A small share of inputs produces most of the output	Richard Koch

● Slibrary 16 — AI Workflow & Judgment pp. 86–90

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p. 87	Delegate–Verify–Own Loop AI drafts, you verify, you remain accountable	Amershi et al.
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p. 89	The Jagged Frontier Capability is uneven and the edge is invisible	Dell'Acqua et al.
p. 90	AI Attribution Ladder Disclosure rungs from no use to substantive generation	UNESCO

How to Use This Library

Every framework in MASCO101 has one A4 sheet, and every sheet has a fixed page number.

The three ways in

1. **Thumbnail card** — the Framework Gallery on each unit page shows the figure, the name and a one-line definition.
2. **Quick look** — clicking a card opens the full definition, the figure, four key points and the reference.
3. **This sheet** — *View Full A4 Reference Sheet* opens the library here, at the right page.

Finding a sheet by hand

Sheets run in Slibrary order, five to a Slibrary:

$$\text{page} = 10 + 5 \times (\text{Slibrary} - 1) + \text{sheet}$$

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Citing a framework

Each sheet carries the original source in Harvard style. Cite the original author, never this library — the sheets are a teaching summary, not the scholarship itself. Where a framework is contested or widely over-generalised, the key points say so; repeat that caveat when you use it.

A note on the figures

The diagrams are deliberately schematic. They are memory hooks that carry the shape of an idea, in the spirit of Thumbnail Thinking, not data visualisations. Read the definition and the source before you rely on the picture.

SMART Goal Frame

A goal-setting test requiring every objective to be Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant and Time-bound before it counts as a commitment.

Five-part test that turns an intention into a commitment



KEY POINTS

- Specific: names the actor and the action
- Measurable: states the evidence of completion
- Achievable and Relevant: fits capacity and strategy
- Time-bound: carries a date, not a season

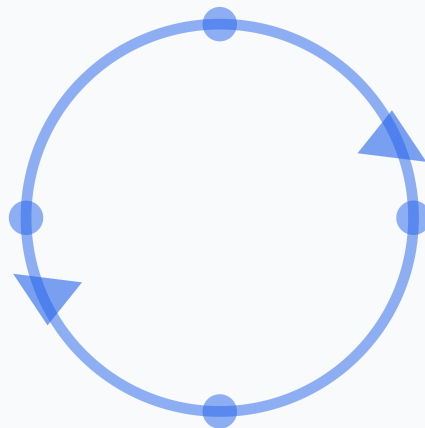
REFERENCE

Doran, G.T. (1981) 'There's a S.M.A.R.T. way to write management's goals and objectives', Management Review, 70(11), pp. 35–36.

Kolb Experiential Learning Cycle

A four-stage loop in which concrete experience becomes learning only after reflection, conceptualisation and deliberate re-testing.

Experience → reflect → conceptualise → test, then repeat



KEY POINTS

- Concrete experience: something actually happens
- Reflective observation: what did I notice?
- Abstract conceptualisation: what rule explains it?
- Active experimentation: test the rule on purpose

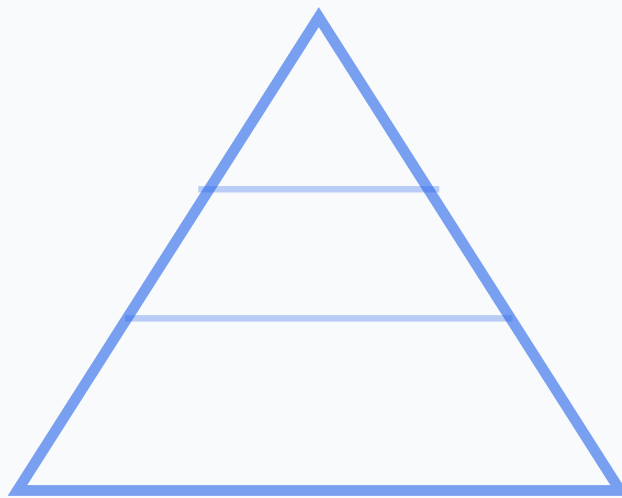
REFERENCE

Kolb, D.A. (1984) *Experiential Learning: Experience as the Source of Learning and Development*. Englewood Cliffs, NJ: Prentice Hall.

Bloom's Taxonomy (Revised)

A six-level hierarchy of cognitive demand running from remembering facts to creating original work, used to calibrate the difficulty of a task.

Six cognitive levels from remember to create



KEY POINTS

- Remember and Understand: reproduction level
- Apply and Analyse: working level
- Evaluate and Create: Level 7 expectation
- Assessment verbs signal the level demanded

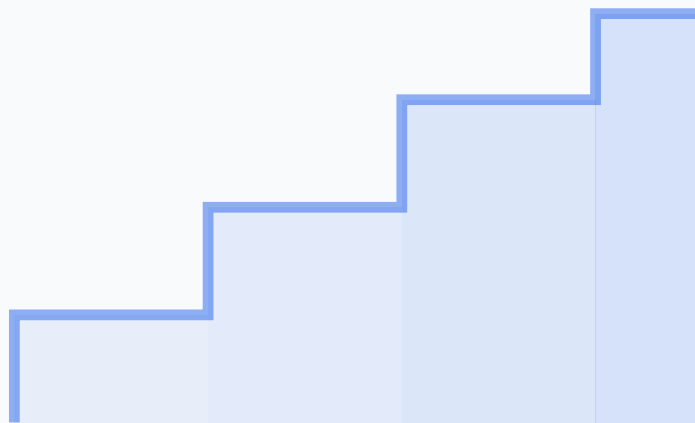
REFERENCE

Anderson, L.W. and Krathwohl, D.R. (eds.) (2001) A Taxonomy for Learning, Teaching, and Assessing. New York: Longman.

Dreyfus Skill Acquisition Model

A five-stage progression from novice to expert in which rule-following gradually gives way to situational, intuitive judgment.

Novice → advanced beginner → competent → proficient → expert



KEY POINTS

- Novices need rules; experts read situations
- Competence begins when you own the outcome
- Expertise is pattern recognition under pressure
- AI can supply rules, not situational judgment

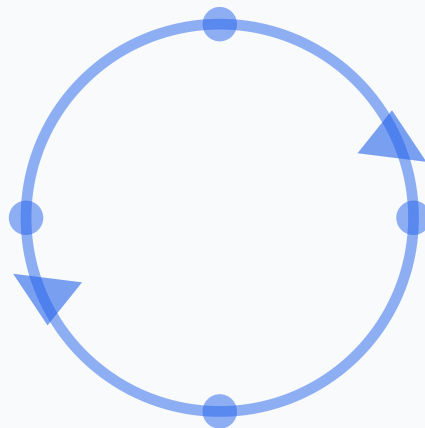
REFERENCE

Dreyfus, S.E. and Dreyfus, H.L. (1980) A Five-Stage Model of the Mental Activities Involved in Directed Skill Acquisition. Berkeley, CA: University of California, Operations Research Center.

Deliberate Practice Loop

A performance-improvement cycle combining a stretch task, immediate feedback and focused repetition on the specific weakness identified.

Stretch task → immediate feedback → targeted repetition



KEY POINTS

- Practice at the edge of current ability
- Feedback must be immediate and specific
- Repetition targets the weakness, not the whole
- Volume without feedback produces plateaus

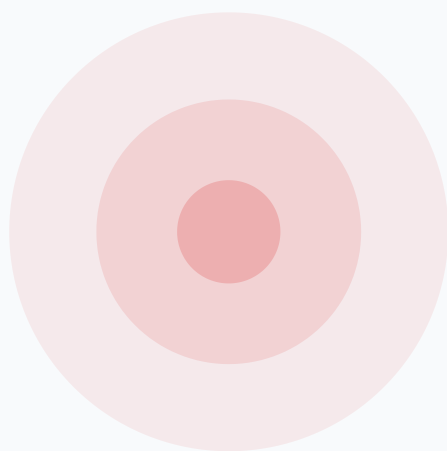
REFERENCE

Ericsson, K.A., Krampe, R.T. and Tesch-Römer, C. (1993) 'The role of deliberate practice in the acquisition of expert performance', *Psychological Review*, 100(3), pp. 363–406.

DigComp 2.2 Competence Wheel

The European reference framework defining digital competence across five areas, from information literacy to problem solving, at eight proficiency levels.

Five competence areas, eight proficiency levels



KEY POINTS

- Information and data literacy
- Communication, collaboration and content creation
- Safety and problem solving
- Includes explicit AI-interaction examples since 2022

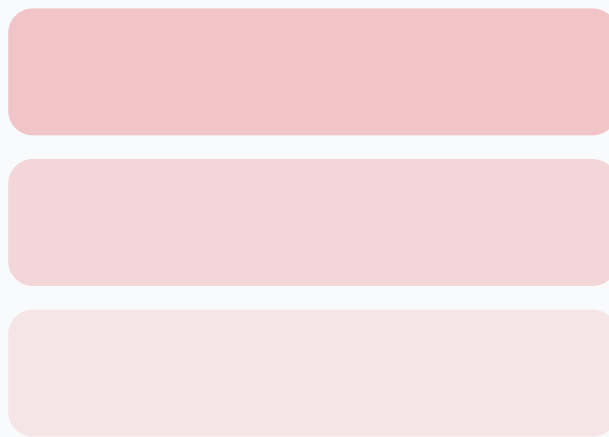
REFERENCE

Vuorikari, R., Kluzer, S. and Punie, Y. (2022) DigComp 2.2: The Digital Competence Framework for Citizens. Luxembourg: Publications Office of the European Union.

CRAAP Source Test

A five-criterion screen — Currency, Relevance, Authority, Accuracy, Purpose — applied to any source before it is allowed into an argument.

Five-criterion screen applied before a source is used



KEY POINTS

- Currency: is it recent enough to still hold?
- Authority and Accuracy: who claims it, on what evidence?
- Purpose: who benefits if you believe it?
- Generative output fails Authority by default

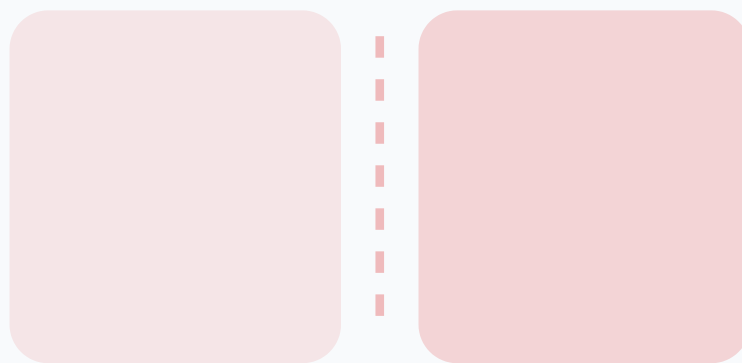
REFERENCE

Blakeslee, S. (2004) 'The CRAAP test', LOEX Quarterly, 31(3), pp. 6–7.

Technology Acceptance Model

A behavioural model predicting technology adoption from two beliefs: perceived usefulness and perceived ease of use.

Usefulness × ease of use predicts actual adoption



KEY POINTS

- Perceived usefulness drives intention most strongly
- Perceived ease of use feeds usefulness
- Explains why good tools go unused
- Adoption is a belief problem, not a feature problem

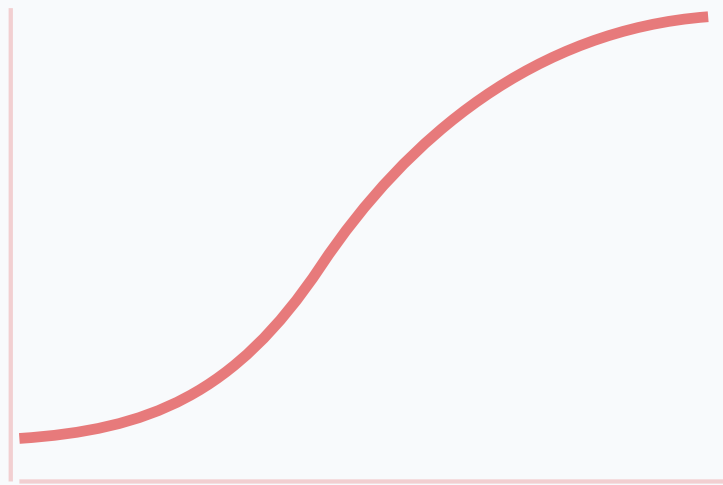
REFERENCE

Davis, F.D. (1989) 'Perceived usefulness, perceived ease of use, and user acceptance of information technology', MIS Quarterly, 13(3), pp. 319–340.

Automation Bias Curve

A reliability model showing how trust in an automated system drifts into over-reliance, causing operators to stop checking outputs they should still verify.

Trust drifts into over-reliance, and checking stops



KEY POINTS

- Use, misuse, disuse and abuse of automation
- Errors of commission: following a wrong output
- Errors of omission: missing what the system skipped
- Verification decays fastest when the tool is usually right

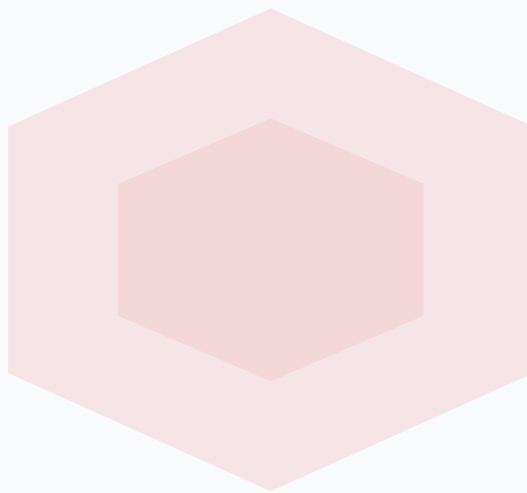
REFERENCE

Parasuraman, R. and Riley, V. (1997) 'Humans and automation: Use, misuse, disuse, abuse', Human Factors, 39(2), pp. 230–253.

Co-Intelligence Working Rules

Four operating principles for working with generative AI: invite it to the table, stay the human in the loop, treat it as a person-like collaborator, and assume this is the worst it will be.

Four operating rules for working with generative AI



KEY POINTS

- Always invite AI to the table, then judge the output
- Be the human in the loop on every decision
- Treat it like a person, but tell it what kind
- Assume today's model is the weakest you will use

REFERENCE

Mollick, E. (2024) Co-Intelligence: Living and Working with AI. New York: Portfolio/Penguin.

Personal SWOT Matrix

A 2×2 diagnostic separating internal strengths and weaknesses from external opportunities and threats, applied to a career rather than a firm.

Internal strengths and gaps against external forces



KEY POINTS

- Internal: strengths and weaknesses you own
- External: opportunities and threats you face
- Pair cells to generate strategies, not lists
- Weakness plus threat is the priority quadrant

REFERENCE

Weihrich, H. (1982) 'The TOWS matrix — a tool for situational analysis', Long Range Planning, 15(2), pp. 54–66.

Johari Window

A four-pane model of self-knowledge splitting what is known to self and to others into open, blind, hidden and unknown areas.

Open, blind, hidden and unknown areas of the self



KEY POINTS

- Open area grows through disclosure
- Blind area shrinks only through feedback
- Hidden area is what you choose not to show
- The blind pane is where careers stall

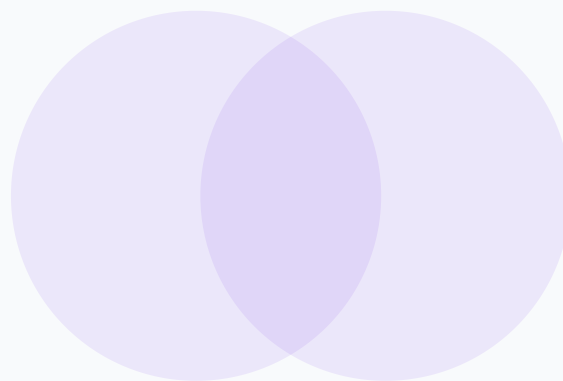
REFERENCE

Luft, J. and Ingham, H. (1955) 'The Johari window, a graphic model of interpersonal awareness', Proceedings of the Western Training Laboratory in Group Development. Los Angeles: UCLA.

Ikigai Purpose Venn

A four-circle overlap locating sustainable purpose where what you love, what you are good at, what the world needs and what you can be paid for intersect.

Purpose sits where four circles overlap



KEY POINTS

- Love × skill = passion
- Skill × payment = profession
- Need × payment = vocation
- All four overlapping is the working target

REFERENCE

García, H. and Miralles, F. (2016) Ikigai: The Japanese Secret to a Long and Happy Life. London: Hutchinson.

Firm Foundation: Vision, Mission, Values

A three-pillar base in which vision states where you are going, mission states what you do, and values state what you will not trade away.

Vision, mission and values as a personal base



KEY POINTS

- Vision: the destination you are aiming at
- Mission: the work you do to get there
- Values: the constraints you refuse to break
- Mindsets sit above the three pillars

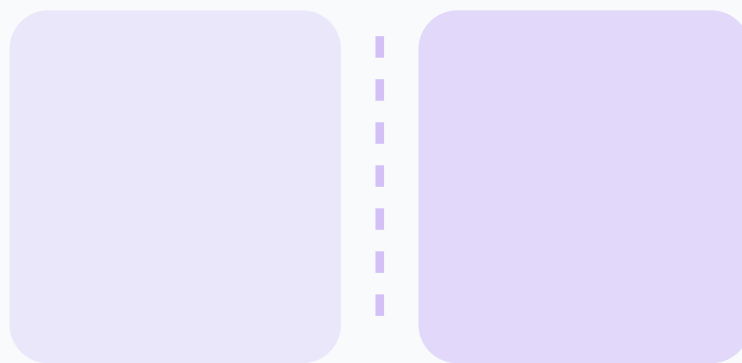
REFERENCE

Meier, J.D. (2010) Getting Results the Agile Way: A Personal Results System for Work and Life. Bellevue, WA: Innovation Playhouse.

Personal Energy Model

A two-column map of the inner core — mind, body, emotions, spirit — against the outer world of environment, relationships and social demands.

Inner core against outer world as an energy audit



KEY POINTS

- Inner core: mind, body, emotions, spirit
- Outer world: environment, relationships, social
- Energy, not hours, is the scarce resource
- Audit the drained column before adding tools

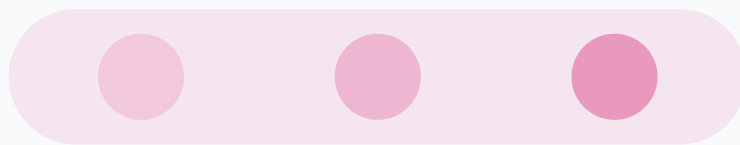
REFERENCE

Meier, J.D. (2010) Getting Results the Agile Way: A Personal Results System for Work and Life. Bellevue, WA: Innovation Playhouse.

MBTI Four Dichotomies

A preference typology sorting individuals along four axes — energy source, information intake, decision basis and outer-world orientation.

Four preference axes describing working style



KEY POINTS

- Extraversion–Introversion: where energy comes from
- Sensing–Intuition: how information is taken in
- Thinking–Feeling: how decisions get made
- Preference, not ability — read it as a hypothesis

REFERENCE

Myers, I.B. and McCaulley, M.H. (1985) Manual: A Guide to the Development and Use of the Myers-Briggs Type Indicator. Palo Alto, CA: Consulting Psychologists Press.

DISC Behavioural Quadrant

A behavioural 2×2 plotting pace against orientation to produce four observable styles: dominance, influence, steadiness and conscientiousness.

Four observable behavioural styles on a 2×2



KEY POINTS

- Dominance: fast, task-focused, direct
- Influence: fast, people-focused, expressive
- Steadiness: steady, people-focused, supportive
- Conscientiousness: steady, task-focused, precise

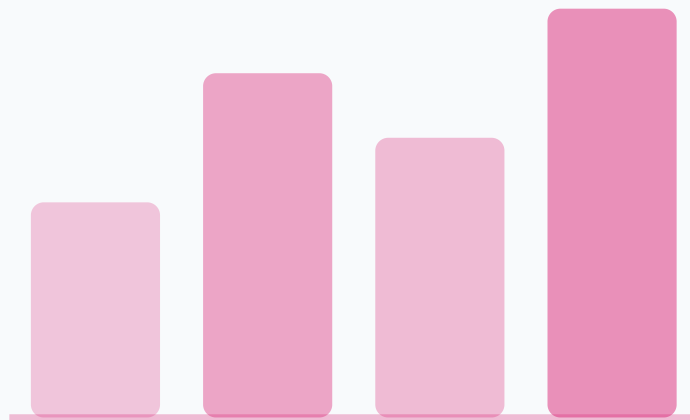
REFERENCE

Marston, W.M. (1928) Emotions of Normal People. London: Kegan Paul, Trench, Trubner & Co.

Big Five (OCEAN)

The five-factor personality model — openness, conscientiousness, extraversion, agreeableness, neuroticism — the most empirically supported trait structure.

Five empirically supported personality dimensions



KEY POINTS

- Traits are continua, not categories
- Conscientiousness best predicts job performance
- Stable over time but not fixed for life
- The strongest evidence base of the profiling tools

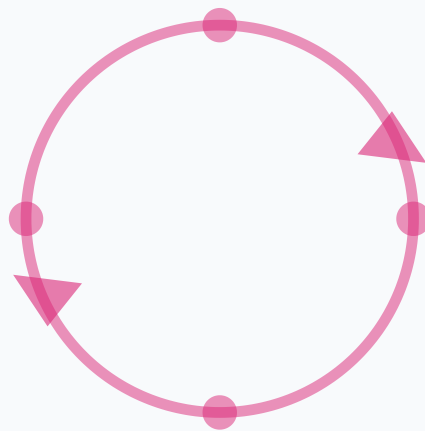
REFERENCE

Costa, P.T. and McCrae, R.R. (1992) Revised NEO Personality Inventory (NEO-PI-R) and NEO Five-Factor Inventory (NEO-FFI) Professional Manual. Odessa, FL: Psychological Assessment Resources.

Honey & Mumford Learning Styles

A four-style map of learning preference — activist, reflector, theorist, pragmatist — mapped onto the stages of the experiential learning cycle.

Four learning preferences mapped onto Kolb's cycle



KEY POINTS

- Activist: learns by doing it first
- Reflector: learns by watching and reviewing
- Theorist: learns by building the model
- Pragmatist: learns by applying it immediately

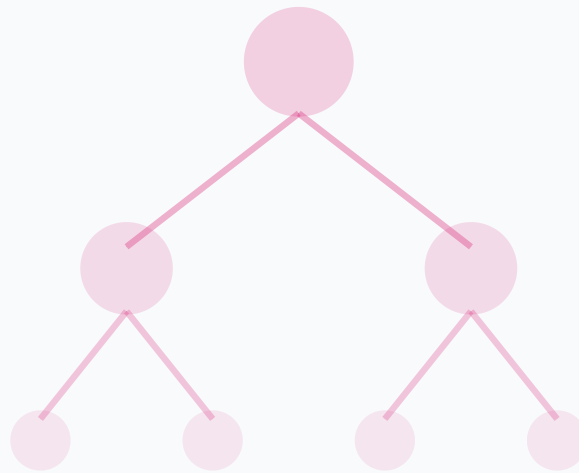
REFERENCE

Honey, P. and Mumford, A. (1986) The Manual of Learning Styles. Maidenhead: Peter Honey Publications.

Growth vs. Fixed Mindset Fork

A branching model in which the belief that ability is fixed or developable determines the response to difficulty, criticism and the success of others.

How the belief about ability changes the response to failure



KEY POINTS

- Fixed: effort signals lack of talent
- Growth: effort is the mechanism of ability
- The fork appears at the moment of failure
- Feedback is threat or data depending on branch

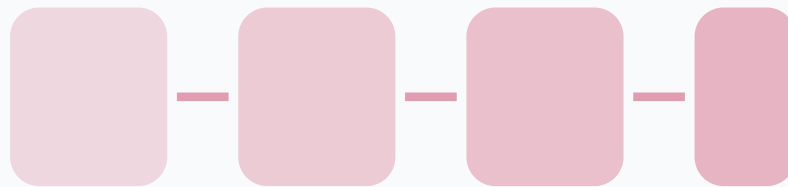
REFERENCE

Dweck, C.S. (2006) Mindset: The New Psychology of Success. New York: Random House.

SCQA Structure

A four-part opening — situation, complication, question, answer — that establishes shared ground before introducing the problem and the recommendation.

Situation, complication, question, answer



KEY POINTS

- Situation: the agreed, uncontested starting point
- Complication: what changed and why it matters
- Question: the single question this raises
- Answer: your recommendation, stated up front

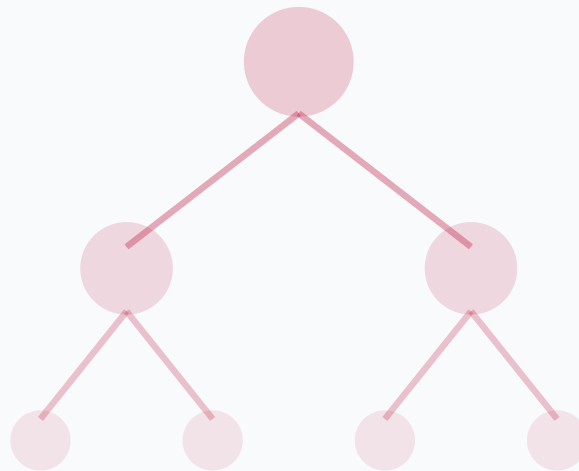
REFERENCE

Minto, B. (1996) The Pyramid Principle: Logic in Writing and Thinking. London: Minto International.

MECE Issue Tree

A decomposition of a problem into branches that are mutually exclusive and collectively exhaustive, so nothing is double-counted and nothing is missed.

Branches that never overlap and never leave a gap



KEY POINTS

- Mutually exclusive: no branch overlaps another
- Collectively exhaustive: nothing falls outside
- Decompose before you gather any data
- The tree is the research plan

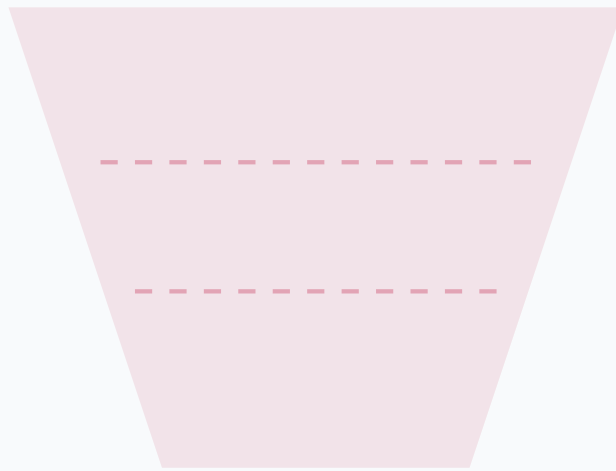
REFERENCE

Rasiel, E.M. (1999) The McKinsey Way. New York: McGraw-Hill.

First Principles Decomposition

A reasoning method that strips a problem back to the assumptions that cannot be reduced further, then rebuilds the solution from those alone.

Strip to irreducible assumptions, then rebuild



KEY POINTS

- List every assumption you are carrying
- Test which ones are physics and which are habit
- Discard the inherited constraints
- Rebuild upward from what actually holds

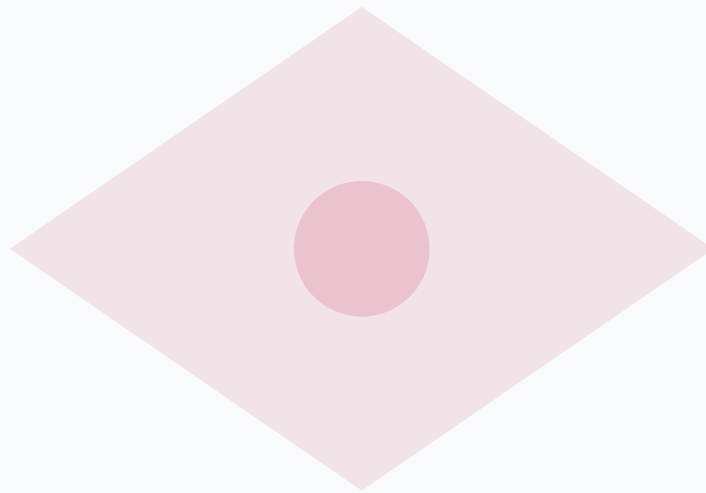
REFERENCE

Wertheimer, M. (1945) Productive Thinking. New York: Harper & Brothers.

Double Diamond

A four-phase design process alternating divergence and convergence twice: discover, define, develop, deliver.

Diverge, converge, diverge, converge



KEY POINTS

- Discover: widen the problem space
- Define: converge on the problem worth solving
- Develop: widen the solution space
- Deliver: converge on what ships

REFERENCE

Design Council (2005) The Design Process: What is the Double Diamond? London: Design Council.

Cynefin Framework

A sense-making model sorting situations into clear, complicated, complex and chaotic domains, each demanding a different decision approach.

Four domains, four different ways to decide



KEY POINTS

- Clear: sense, categorise, apply best practice
- Complicated: sense, analyse, apply expertise
- Complex: probe, sense, respond — experiment
- Chaotic: act first, then sense and respond

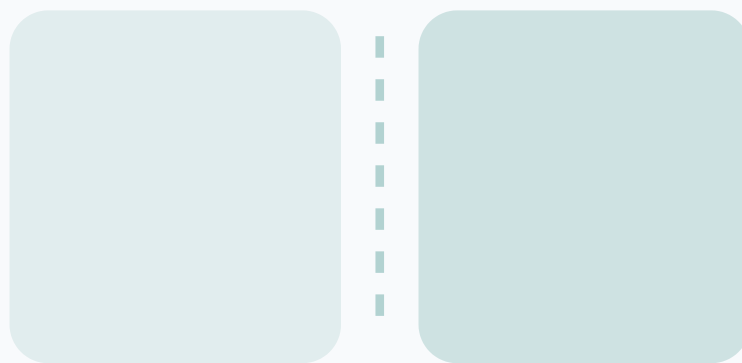
REFERENCE

Snowden, D.J. and Boone, M.E. (2007) 'A leader's framework for decision making', Harvard Business Review, 85(11), pp. 68–76.

System 1 / System 2

A dual-process model separating fast, automatic, intuitive judgment from slow, effortful, deliberate reasoning — and explaining when the fast system misfires.

Fast automatic judgment against slow deliberate reasoning



KEY POINTS

- System 1: fast, automatic, always running
- System 2: slow, effortful, easily fatigued
- Most errors are System 1 going unchecked
- Fluent AI output is a System 1 trigger

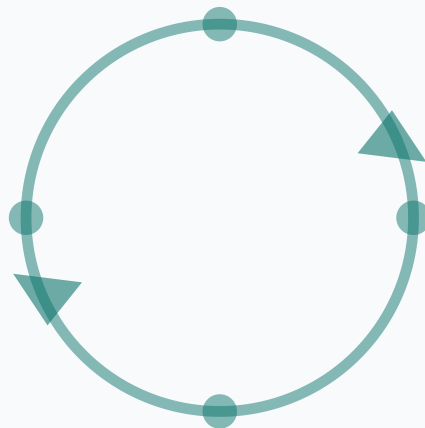
REFERENCE

Kahneman, D. (2011) Thinking, Fast and Slow. New York: Farrar, Straus and Giroux.

Confirmation Bias Loop

A self-reinforcing cycle in which a held belief shapes what evidence is sought, how it is read, and what is remembered.

Belief shapes search, reading and recall



KEY POINTS

- Search: you look where the answer already is
- Interpretation: contrary data is discounted
- Recall: supporting cases come to mind first
- Countermeasure: assign someone to disconfirm

REFERENCE

Nickerson, R.S. (1998) 'Confirmation bias: A ubiquitous phenomenon in many guises', *Review of General Psychology*, 2(2), pp. 175–220.

Anchoring & Adjustment

A judgment heuristic in which an initial reference value — however arbitrary — pulls the final estimate towards itself.

The first number quoted pulls every later estimate



KEY POINTS

- The anchor need not be relevant to bite
- Adjustment from the anchor is nearly always too small
- Whoever states the first figure sets the range
- Prepare your own anchor before the meeting

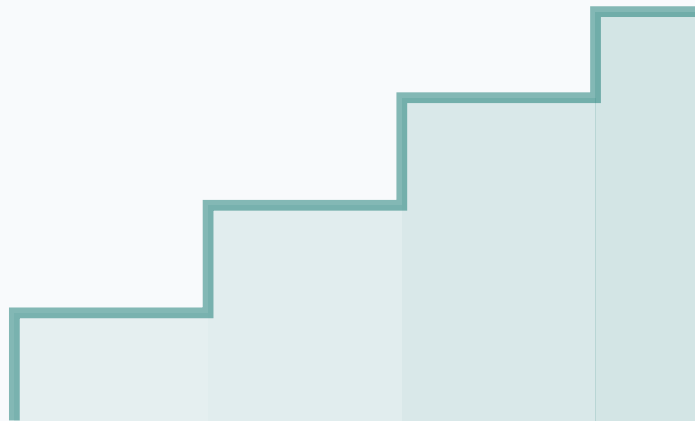
REFERENCE

Tversky, A. and Kahneman, D. (1974) 'Judgment under uncertainty: Heuristics and biases', Science, 185(4157), pp. 1124–1131.

Ladder of Inference

A seven-rung climb from observable data through selection, meaning, assumption and conclusion to action — usually made in under a second.

Seven rungs from raw data to action



KEY POINTS

- Rung 1: observable data everyone could see
- Middle rungs: selection, meaning, assumption
- Top rungs: belief and action
- Ask which rung a disagreement started on

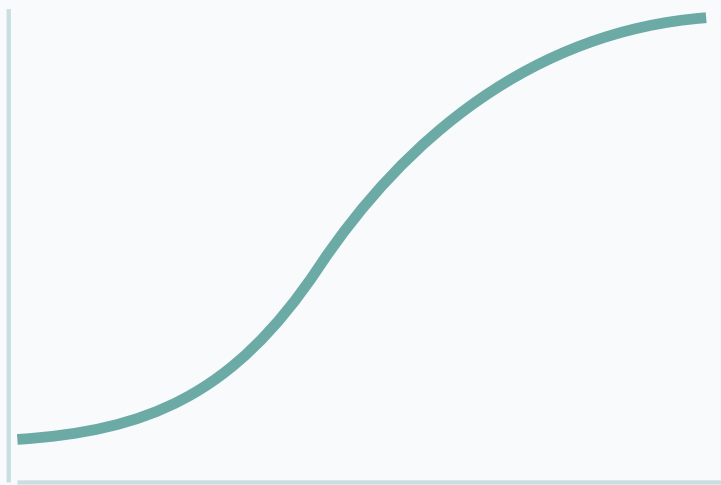
REFERENCE

Argyris, C. (1990) Overcoming Organizational Defenses: Facilitating Organizational Learning. Boston, MA: Allyn and Bacon.

Dunning–Kruger Curve

A competence-confidence curve showing that the least skilled tend to overestimate their ability most, because the skill needed to perform is the skill needed to judge performance.

Confidence peaks before competence does



KEY POINTS

- Low skill, high confidence at the early peak
- Confidence falls as competence reveals the gap
- Recovery brings calibrated confidence
- Applies sharply to first-time AI users

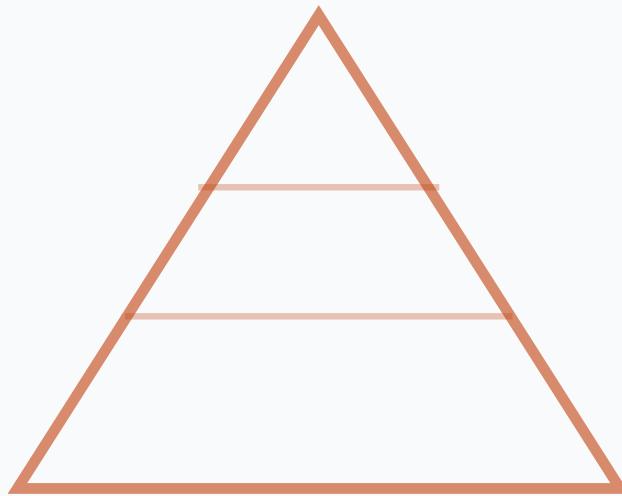
REFERENCE

Kruger, J. and Dunning, D. (1999) 'Unskilled and unaware of it', *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 77(6), pp. 1121–1134.

Brand Pyramid

A layered model building from context and target audience through needs and offering to the story and the purpose at the apex.

From context at the base to purpose at the apex



KEY POINTS

- Context: the forces acting on the brand
- Audience and offering: who and what
- Truths and story: the ten-second pitch
- Purpose: why the audience believes you exist

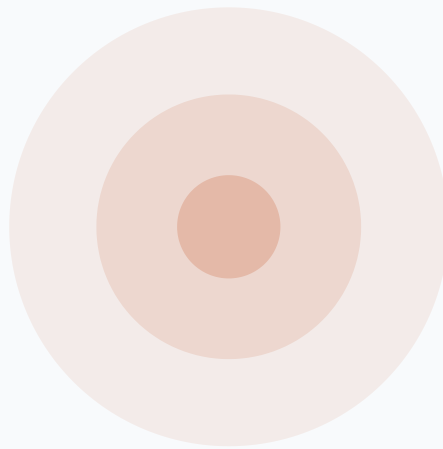
REFERENCE

Aaker, D.A. (1996) Building Strong Brands. New York: Free Press.

Twelve Brand Archetypes

A wheel of twelve recognisable identities — from Innocent to Ruler — grouped by four core motivations, used to make positioning instantly legible.

Twelve identities grouped by four core motivations



KEY POINTS

- Provide structure: Ruler, Creator, Caregiver
- Seek paradise: Innocent, Sage, Explorer
- Leave a mark: Hero, Magician, Outlaw
- Connect: Everyman, Jester, Lover

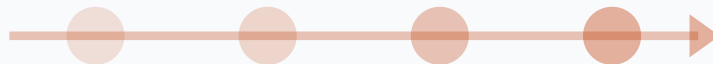
REFERENCE

Mark, M. and Pearson, C.S. (2001) The Hero and the Outlaw: Building Extraordinary Brands Through the Power of Archetypes. New York: McGraw-Hill.

StoryBrand SB7 Framework

A seven-part narrative in which the audience is the hero with a problem, and you are the guide who offers a plan and calls them to act.

The audience is the hero; you are the guide



KEY POINTS

- A character with a problem
- Meets a guide who gives them a plan
- Who calls them to action
- Avoiding failure and ending in success

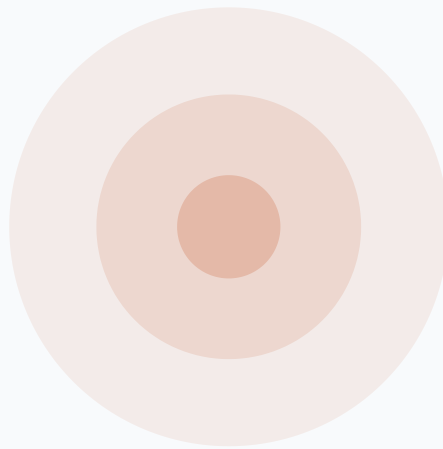
REFERENCE

Miller, D. (2017) Building a StoryBrand: Clarify Your Message So Customers Will Listen. Nashville, TN: HarperCollins Leadership.

Golden Circle

A three-ring model arguing that communication should start from why, move to how, and reach what last.

Start from why, then how, then what



KEY POINTS

- Why: the belief that drives the work
- How: the distinctive method
- What: the deliverable itself
- Most people pitch the rings backwards

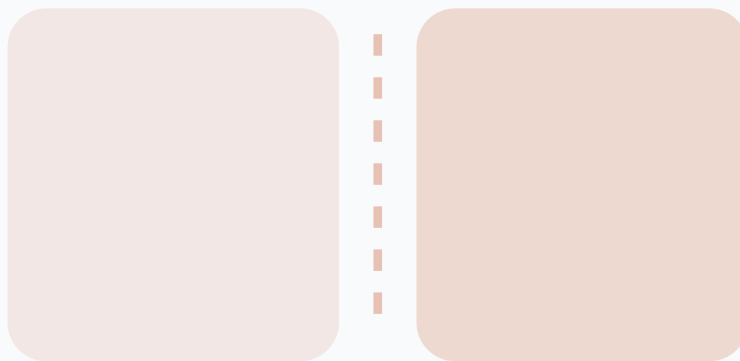
REFERENCE

Sinek, S. (2009) Start With Why: How Great Leaders Inspire Everyone to Take Action. New York: Portfolio/Penguin.

Personal Value Proposition Canvas

A two-sided fit test matching what an audience needs — jobs, pains, gains — against what you actually offer.

Match their jobs, pains and gains to your offer



KEY POINTS

- Their side: jobs to be done, pains, gains
- Your side: offer, pain relievers, gain creators
- Fit is proven by evidence, not assertion
- Rewrite the offer, not the audience

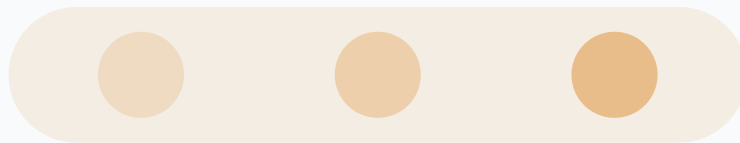
REFERENCE

Osterwalder, A., Pigneur, Y., Bernarda, G. and Smith, A. (2014) Value Proposition Design. Hoboken, NJ: Wiley.

Message Strategy Spectrum

A continuum from convince to clarify, where motivational content builds trust in the message and informational content unpacks its detail.

Convince at one end, clarify at the other



KEY POINTS

- Convince: motivational, why it matters, builds trust
- Clarify: informational, what it is, unpacks detail
- Read audience skill, awareness and resistance
- Every message is a blend, not a pole

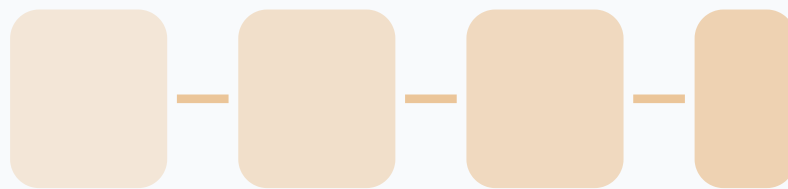
REFERENCE

Bostelaar, K. (2024) Clarify Your Core Message. Leverlo Playbook. Available at: leverlo.com.

Problem → Insight → Recommendation

A three-beat pitch structure that names the problem, delivers the non-obvious insight, and closes on a specific recommendation.

Three beats: problem, insight, recommendation



KEY POINTS

- Problem: the tension the audience already feels
- Insight: the thing they had not seen
- Recommendation: one specific, testable ask
- Ninety seconds is the working constraint

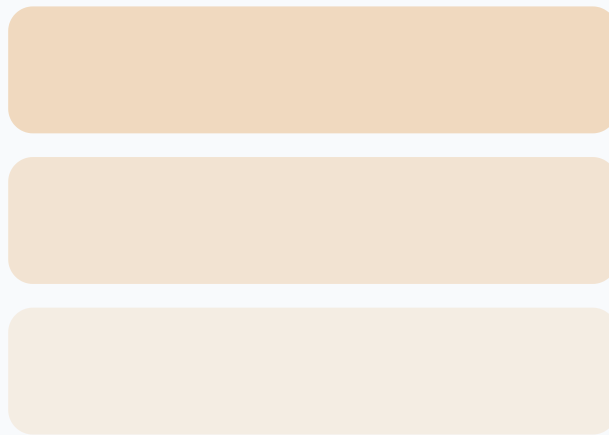
REFERENCE

Gallo, C. (2014) Talk Like TED: The 9 Public-Speaking Secrets of the World's Top Minds. New York: St. Martin's Press.

Assertion–Evidence Slide Model

A slide design rule replacing topic headers and bullet lists with a full-sentence assertion supported by a single visual.

One sentence claim, one supporting visual, no bullets



KEY POINTS

- Headline states a claim, not a topic
- Body carries visual evidence for that claim
- Bullet lists split attention and reduce recall
- One slide carries exactly one assertion

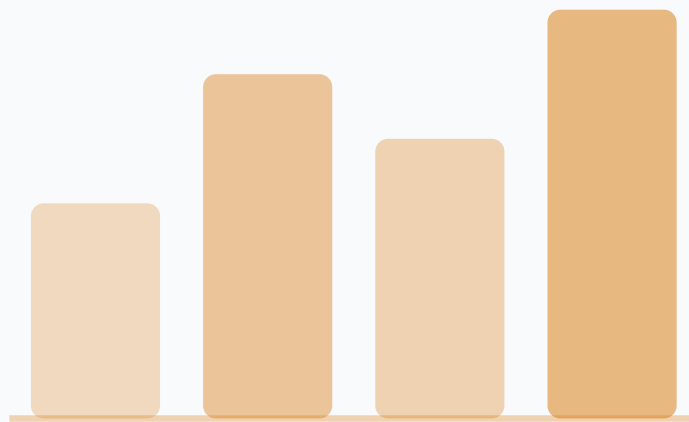
REFERENCE

Alley, M. (2013) The Craft of Scientific Presentations. 2nd edn. New York: Springer.

Mehrabian 7–38–55

A finding that when words and delivery conflict in emotional messages, listeners weight tone and expression far above the words themselves.

When words and delivery conflict, delivery wins



KEY POINTS

- 7% words, 38% tone, 55% expression
- Holds only for conflicting emotional signals
- Widely over-generalised — cite it carefully
- Useful point: incongruence destroys credibility

REFERENCE

Mehrabian, A. (1971) Silent Messages. Belmont, CA: Wadsworth.

Anxiety Reappraisal

A pre-performance technique that relabels arousal as excitement rather than suppressing it, improving observed performance under pressure.

Relabel nerves as excitement instead of suppressing them



KEY POINTS

- Arousal is the same physiologically either way
- Saying 'I am excited' outperforms 'calm down'
- Opportunity framing beats threat framing
- Works because arousal cannot be switched off

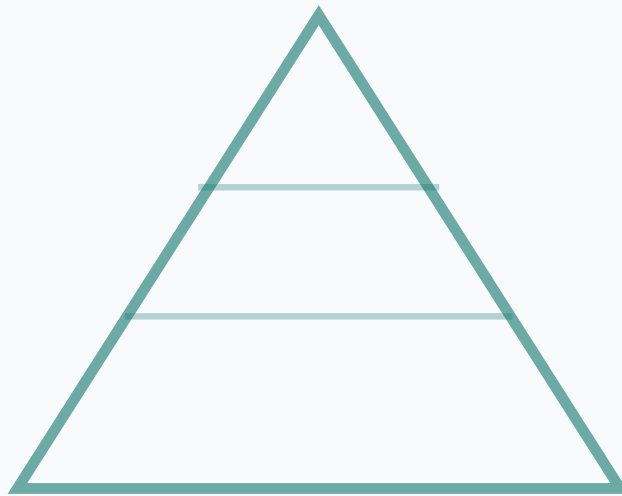
REFERENCE

Brooks, A.W. (2014) 'Get excited: Reappraising pre-performance anxiety as excitement', Journal of Experimental Psychology: General, 143(3), pp. 1144–1158.

Pyramid Principle

A writing structure placing the single governing answer at the top, supported by grouped arguments that are themselves supported by evidence.

Answer at the top, grouped support beneath



KEY POINTS

- Start with the answer, not the journey
- Group supporting ideas into three to five
- Each group summarises the level below it
- Order the groups by a stated logic

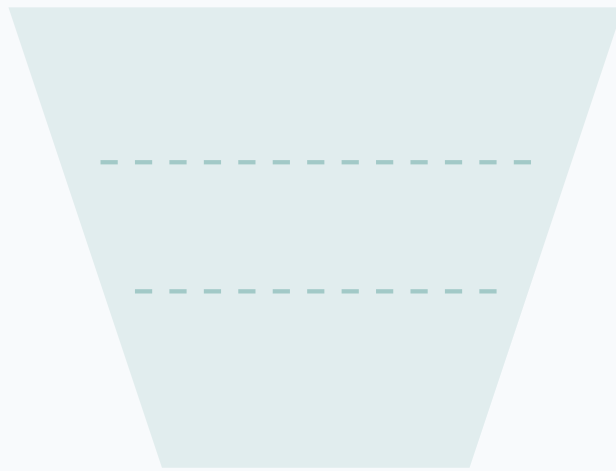
REFERENCE

Minto, B. (1996) The Pyramid Principle: Logic in Writing and Thinking. London: Minto International.

Distil → Decompose → Prioritise

A message-refinement worksheet moving from a full paragraph, to a list of component concepts, to a forced ranking, to a single sentence.

From a paragraph to one defensible sentence



KEY POINTS

- Write the whole thing at length first
- Decompose into isolated concepts
- Force-rank from least to most important
- Compress to three sentences, then to one

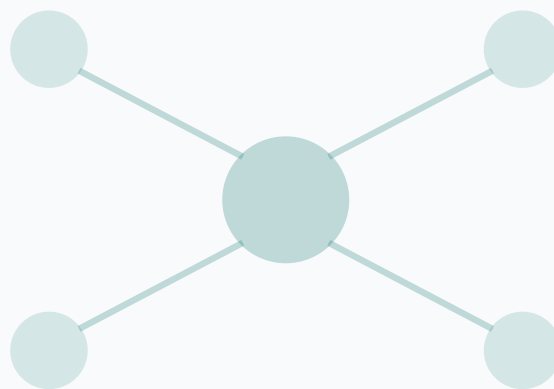
REFERENCE

Bostelaar, K. (2024) Clarify Your Core Message. Leverlo Playbook. Available at: leverlo.com.

Toulmin Argument Model

A six-part anatomy of an argument — claim, grounds, warrant, backing, qualifier, rebuttal — that exposes the unstated link doing the work.

Six parts, including the warrant nobody states



KEY POINTS

- Claim: what you want accepted
- Grounds: the evidence offered
- Warrant: the unstated link between the two
- Qualifier and rebuttal: the honest limits

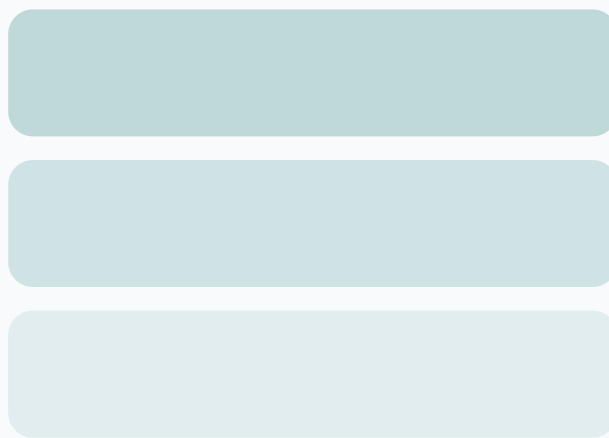
REFERENCE

Toulmin, S.E. (1958) The Uses of Argument. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

BLUF Executive Structure

A document pattern placing the bottom line — decision required, recommendation, implication — in the opening lines, before any supporting detail.

Bottom line up front, detail underneath



KEY POINTS

- Line one states the decision required
- Supporting logic follows, not precedes
- Detail moves to annexes, not the body
- Optimised for readers who stop after 30 seconds

REFERENCE

Doumont, J.-L. (2009) Trees, Maps, and Theorems: Effective Communication for Rational Minds. Kraainem: Principiae.

Storyline Canvas

A canvas mapping plot — beginning, middle, end — against character transformation — misbelief, insight, understanding — so a story teaches a specific lesson.

Plot across the top, character change beneath



KEY POINTS

- Plot: beginning, middle, end
- Character: misbelief, insight, understanding
- Story: setup, conflict, conclusion
- The life lesson is your core message

REFERENCE

Bostelaar, K. (2024) Craft Stories to Teach and Explain. Leverlo Playbook. Available at: leverlo.com.

Shannon–Weaver Model

A transmission model of communication tracing a message from source through encoding, channel and noise to decoding and receiver.

Source, encode, channel, noise, decode, receiver



KEY POINTS

- Noise degrades the signal at every stage
- Encoding and decoding use different codebooks
- Feedback is the only proof of receipt
- Most failures are decoding, not sending

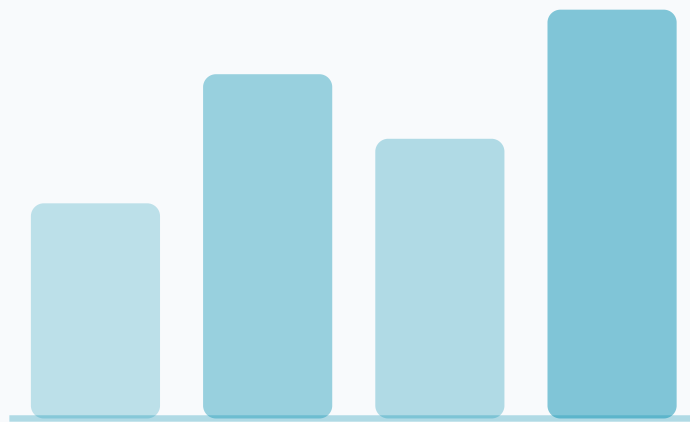
REFERENCE

Shannon, C.E. and Weaver, W. (1949) The Mathematical Theory of Communication. Urbana, IL: University of Illinois Press.

Hofstede Cultural Dimensions

Six national-culture dimensions — including power distance, individualism and uncertainty avoidance — used to anticipate how a message will land.

Six national-culture dimensions that shape reception



KEY POINTS

- Power distance shapes who may disagree openly
- Individualism shapes whether credit is shared
- Uncertainty avoidance shapes appetite for ambiguity
- Country averages, never individual predictions

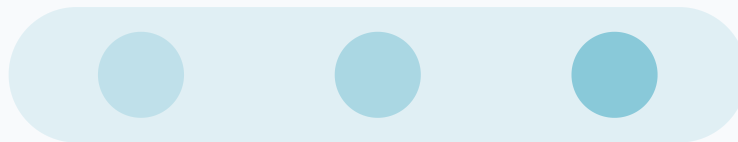
REFERENCE

Hofstede, G. (2001) Culture's Consequences: Comparing Values, Behaviors, Institutions and Organizations Across Nations. 2nd edn. Thousand Oaks, CA: Sage.

The Culture Map (Eight Scales)

Eight behavioural scales — communicating, evaluating, persuading, leading, deciding, trusting, disagreeing, scheduling — that position cultures relative to each other.

Eight scales positioning cultures relative to each other



KEY POINTS

- Position is relative, never absolute
- Evaluating: direct against indirect criticism
- Disagreeing: confrontational against avoidant
- Read the gap between two cultures, not one

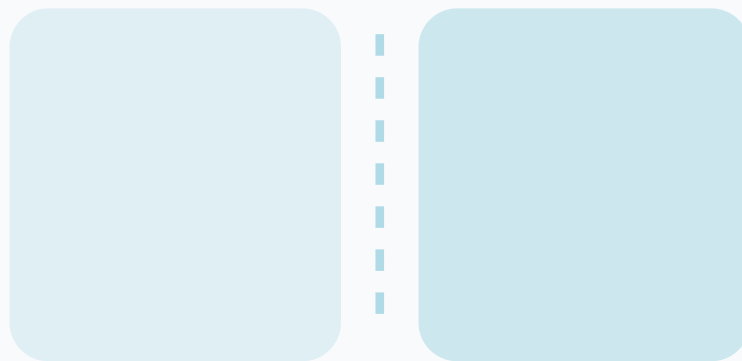
REFERENCE

Meyer, E. (2014) The Culture Map: Breaking Through the Invisible Boundaries of Global Business. New York: PublicAffairs.

High- and Low-Context Communication

A distinction between cultures where meaning sits in shared context and those where meaning must be made explicit in the words themselves.

Meaning carried by context, or by the words alone



KEY POINTS

- Low context: say it, write it, confirm it
- High context: much is understood, not stated
- Written follow-ups read very differently
- Mismatch reads as rude or as vague

REFERENCE

Hall, E.T. (1976) Beyond Culture. New York: Anchor Press/Doubleday.

Power–Interest Grid

A 2×2 mapping stakeholders by power and interest to set the communication effort each one receives.

Power against interest sets communication effort



KEY POINTS

- High power, high interest: manage closely
- High power, low interest: keep satisfied
- Low power, high interest: keep informed
- Re-map when the project changes shape

REFERENCE

Mendelow, A.L. (1981) 'Environmental scanning: The impact of the stakeholder concept', Proceedings of the Second International Conference on Information Systems, pp. 407–417.

Project Lifecycle

The five process groups — initiating, planning, executing, monitoring and controlling, closing — that structure any project regardless of method.

Initiate, plan, execute, monitor, close



KEY POINTS

- Initiating: authorise and appoint
- Planning: scope, schedule, cost, risk, quality
- Executing with monitoring running in parallel
- Closing: handover, lessons, release

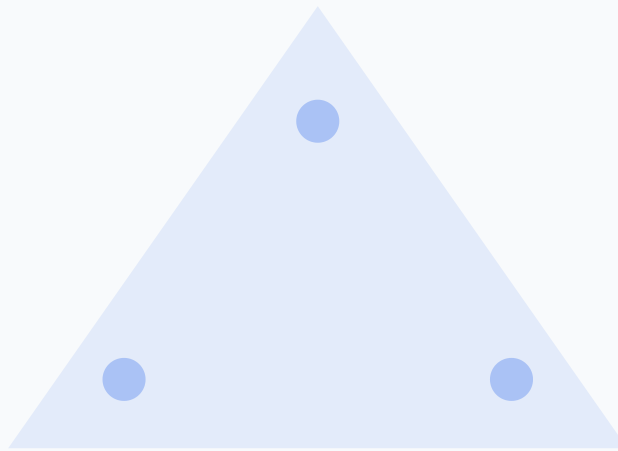
REFERENCE

Project Management Institute (2021) A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge (PMBOK Guide). 7th edn. Newtown Square, PA: PMI.

Iron Triangle

The constraint model in which scope, time and cost are interdependent, so any change to one forces a change in at least one other.

Scope, time and cost cannot all be fixed



KEY POINTS

- Fix any two and the third must move
- Quality sits inside, squeezed by all three
- Most failures are undeclared scope change
- State the trade-off before you accept the change

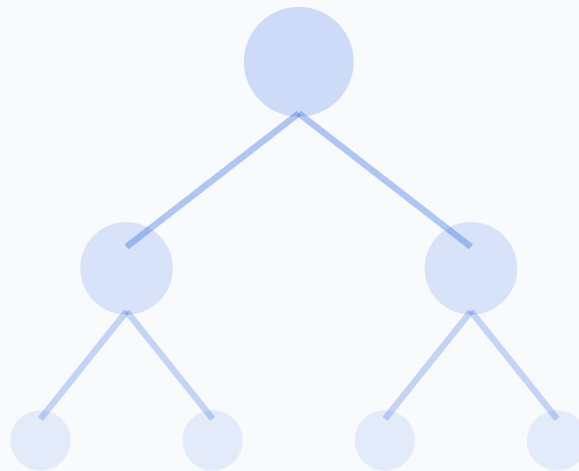
REFERENCE

Atkinson, R. (1999) 'Project management: cost, time and quality, two best guesses and a phenomenon', International Journal of Project Management, 17(6), pp. 337–342.

Work Breakdown Structure

A hierarchical decomposition of the total scope into deliverables and work packages small enough to be estimated and owned.

Scope decomposed into ownable work packages



KEY POINTS

- Deliverable-oriented, not activity-oriented
- 100% rule: the children equal the parent
- Decompose until a package has one owner
- Anything not in the WBS is not in scope

REFERENCE

Project Management Institute (2019) Practice Standard for Work Breakdown Structures. 3rd edn. Newtown Square, PA: PMI.

Gantt Chart

A horizontal bar schedule plotting tasks against calendar time to show duration, sequence and overlap at a glance.

Tasks against calendar time, with dependencies



KEY POINTS

- Bar length is duration, position is timing
- Dependencies show what blocks what
- Milestones mark decision points
- It shows the plan, not the progress

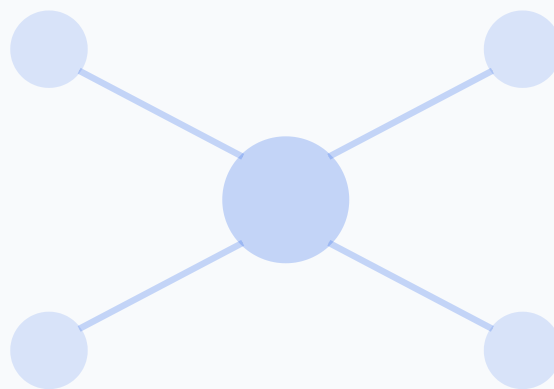
REFERENCE

Clark, W. (1922) The Gantt Chart: A Working Tool of Management. New York: Ronald Press.

Critical Path Method

A scheduling technique identifying the longest chain of dependent tasks, which sets the minimum project duration and has zero float.

The longest dependent chain sets the deadline



KEY POINTS

- Critical path has zero float by definition
- Delay on it delays the whole project
- Float elsewhere is available for reallocation
- Recalculate after every scope change

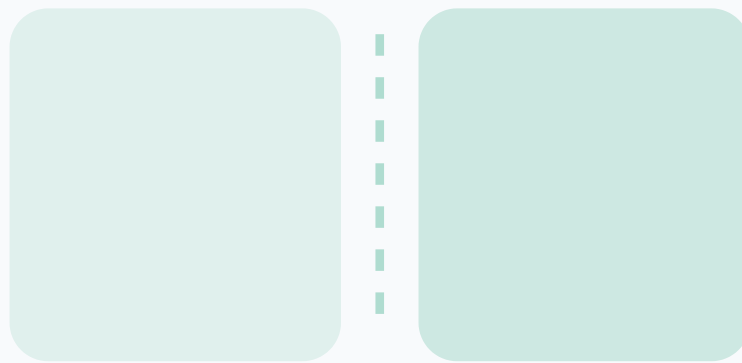
REFERENCE

Kelley, J.E. and Walker, M.R. (1959) 'Critical-path planning and scheduling', Proceedings of the Eastern Joint Computer Conference, pp. 160–173.

Agile Manifesto Values

Four value trade-offs preferring individuals, working output, customer collaboration and responsiveness over process, documentation, contracts and plans.

Four trade-offs, both sides valued, one preferred



KEY POINTS

- Individuals and interactions over processes
- Working software over comprehensive documentation
- Customer collaboration over contract negotiation
- Responding to change over following a plan

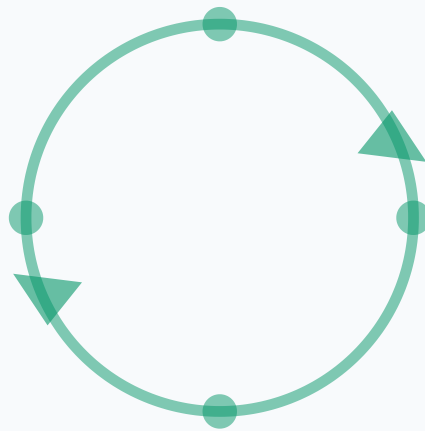
REFERENCE

Beck, K. et al. (2001) Manifesto for Agile Software Development. Available at: agilemanifesto.org.

Scrum Sprint Cycle

A fixed-length iteration containing planning, daily coordination, a review of the increment and a retrospective on the process itself.

Fixed iteration: plan, work, review, retrospect



KEY POINTS

- Sprint length is fixed; scope is not
- Daily coordination surfaces blockers early
- Review inspects the increment with stakeholders
- Retrospective changes how the team works

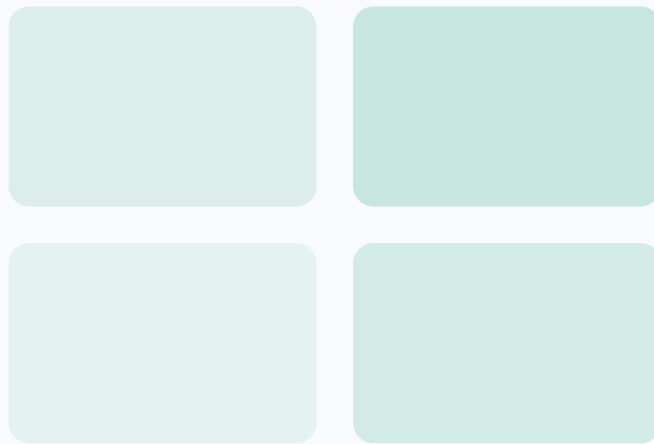
REFERENCE

Schwaber, K. and Sutherland, J. (2020) The Scrum Guide. Available at: [scrumguides.org](https://www.scrumguides.org).

Stacey Matrix

A 2x2 plotting agreement on requirements against certainty of technology, used to choose between plan-driven and adaptive approaches.

Agreement against certainty picks the method



KEY POINTS

- Close to agreement and certainty: plan-driven
- Far from both: adaptive and experimental
- The middle zone is where agile earns its keep
- Method follows the problem, not preference

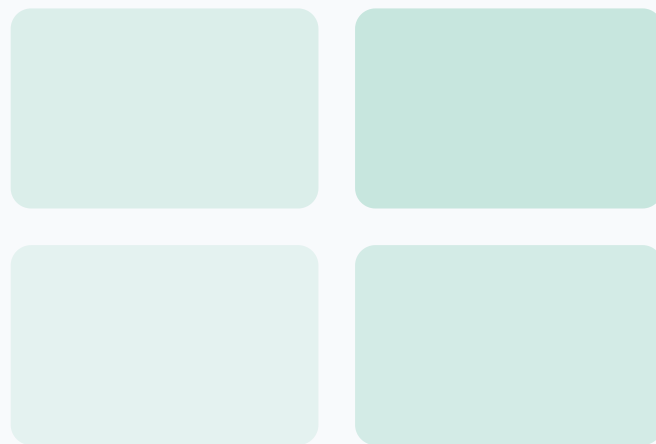
REFERENCE

Stacey, R.D. (1996) Complexity and Creativity in Organizations. San Francisco, CA: Berrett-Koehler.

Probability–Impact Risk Matrix

A grid scoring each identified risk by likelihood and consequence to set the response: avoid, mitigate, transfer or accept.

Likelihood against consequence sets the response



KEY POINTS

- Score likelihood and consequence separately
- High-high: avoid or mitigate now
- Low-high: transfer or build contingency
- Every risk needs a named owner and a trigger

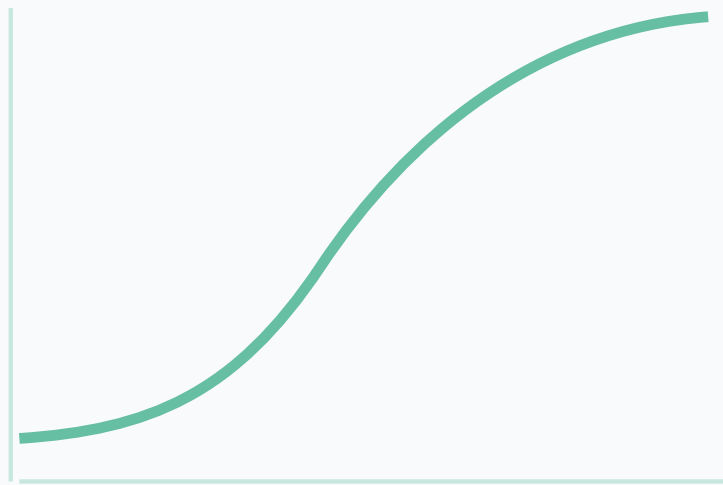
REFERENCE

International Organization for Standardization (2018) ISO 31000:2018 Risk Management — Guidelines. Geneva: ISO.

Earned Value S-Curve

A control technique comparing planned value, earned value and actual cost over time to detect schedule and cost variance early.

Planned, earned and actual plotted against time



KEY POINTS

- Planned value: what should have been done
- Earned value: what was actually delivered
- Actual cost: what it truly consumed
- Variance appears here before it appears in status

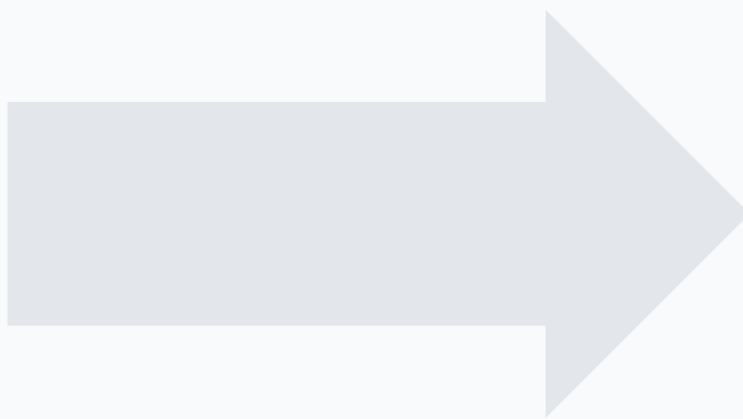
REFERENCE

Project Management Institute (2019) The Standard for Earned Value Management. Newtown Square, PA: PMI.

BATNA

Your best alternative to a negotiated agreement — the outcome you take if this deal fails, and therefore the true source of your leverage.

The outcome you take if this deal fails



KEY POINTS

- Identify it before the first meeting
- Improve it rather than bluffing about it
- It sets your genuine walk-away point
- Estimate theirs; it explains their behaviour

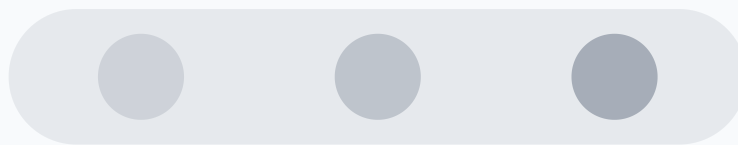
REFERENCE

Fisher, R. and Ury, W. (1981) Getting to Yes: Negotiating Agreement Without Giving In. Boston, MA: Houghton Mifflin.

Zone of Possible Agreement

The overlap between the two parties' reservation points, inside which any deal beats no deal for both sides.

The overlap where a deal beats no deal for both



KEY POINTS

- Bounded by each side's reservation price
- No overlap means no agreement is rational
- Widen it by adding issues, not by conceding
- Most of the work is discovering where it sits

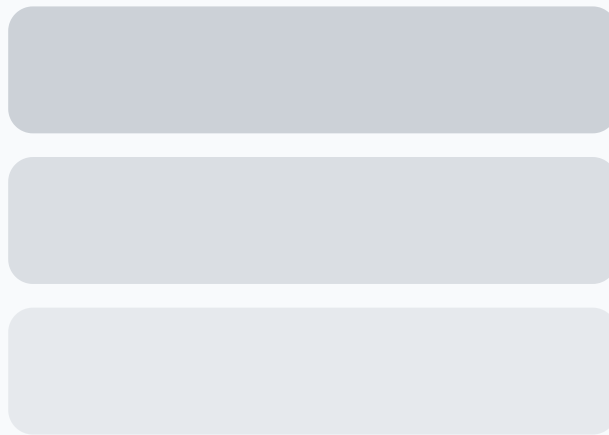
REFERENCE

Raiffa, H. (1982) The Art and Science of Negotiation. Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press.

Principled Negotiation

Four rules: separate the people from the problem, focus on interests not positions, invent options for mutual gain, and insist on objective criteria.

Four rules for negotiating on merits, not will



KEY POINTS

- Separate the people from the problem
- Focus on interests, not stated positions
- Invent options for mutual gain before deciding
- Insist on objective, external criteria

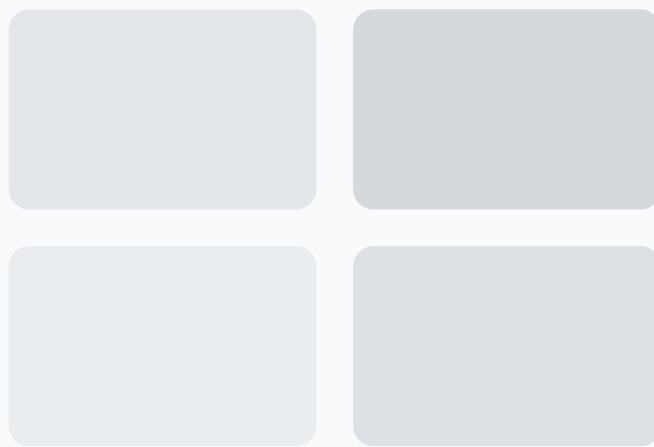
REFERENCE

Fisher, R., Ury, W. and Patton, B. (2011) Getting to Yes: Negotiating Agreement Without Giving In. 3rd edn. New York: Penguin Books.

Dual Concerns Conflict Modes

A 2×2 of concern for own outcomes against concern for the relationship, producing competing, collaborating, compromising, avoiding and accommodating.

Concern for outcome against concern for relationship



KEY POINTS

- Competing: high outcome, low relationship
- Collaborating: high on both, costly in time
- Compromising: the middle default
- No mode is correct — fit it to the stakes

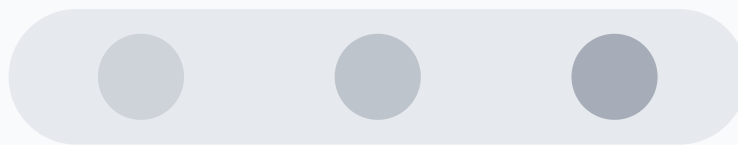
REFERENCE

Thomas, K.W. and Kilmann, R.H. (1974) Thomas-Kilmann Conflict Mode Instrument. Tuxedo, NY: Xicom.

Distributive ↔ Integrative Spectrum

A continuum between claiming value from a fixed pool and creating value by trading across differently valued issues.

Claiming a fixed pool against creating a bigger one



KEY POINTS

- Distributive: one issue, fixed pie, zero sum
- Integrative: many issues, differing priorities
- Trade low-value-to-you for high-value-to-them
- Most real negotiations contain both

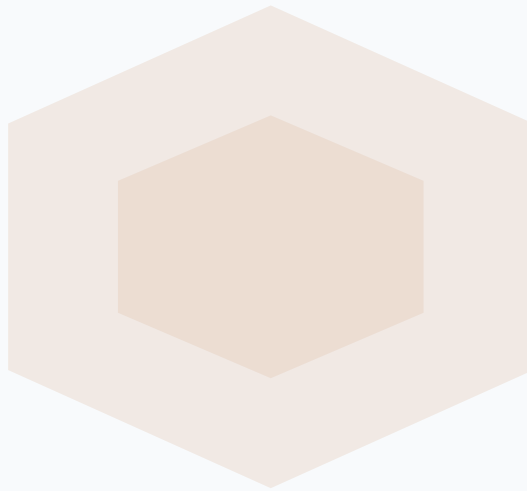
REFERENCE

Walton, R.E. and McKersie, R.B. (1965) A Behavioral Theory of Labor Negotiations. New York: McGraw-Hill.

Six Principles of Influence

Six evidenced levers of compliance: reciprocity, commitment and consistency, social proof, authority, liking and scarcity.

Six evidenced levers of compliance



KEY POINTS

- Reciprocity: give first, specifically
- Commitment: small public agreement precedes large
- Social proof and authority: who else, who says
- Liking and scarcity: rapport and limited windows

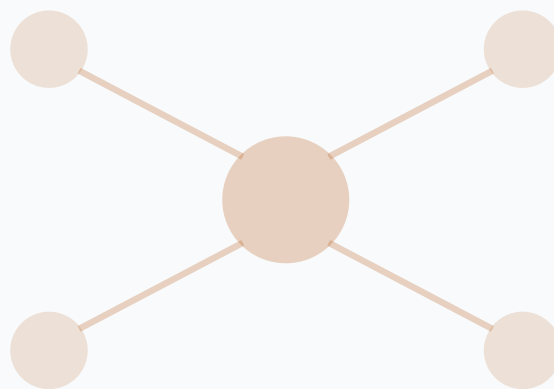
REFERENCE

Cialdini, R.B. (1984) Influence: The Psychology of Persuasion. New York: Harper Business.

French & Raven Power Bases

Five sources of social power — legitimate, reward, coercive, expert and referent — of which only two require a title.

Five power bases; only two need a job title



KEY POINTS

- Legitimate, reward, coercive come with position
- Expert power comes from demonstrated competence
- Referent power comes from being trusted
- Without authority, build expert and referent

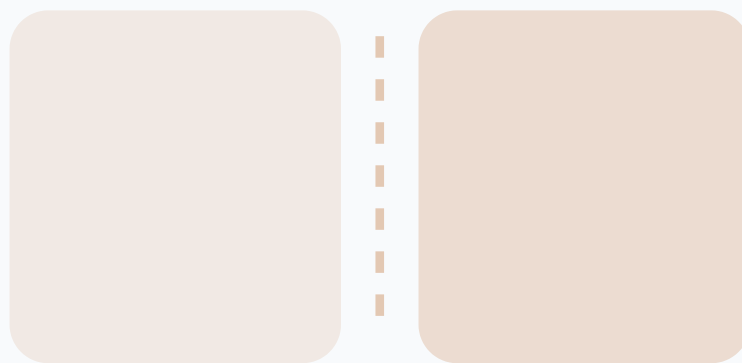
REFERENCE

French, J.R.P. and Raven, B. (1959) 'The bases of social power', in Cartwright, D. (ed.) Studies in Social Power. Ann Arbor, MI: University of Michigan, pp. 150–167.

Influence Currencies

An exchange model treating influence as trade in currencies the other party values — inspiration, task support, position, relationship, personal.

Influence as trade in currencies the other side values



KEY POINTS

- Diagnose what the other party actually needs
- Inspiration, task, position, relationship, personal
- Offer before you ask, in their currency
- Reciprocity is the operating mechanism

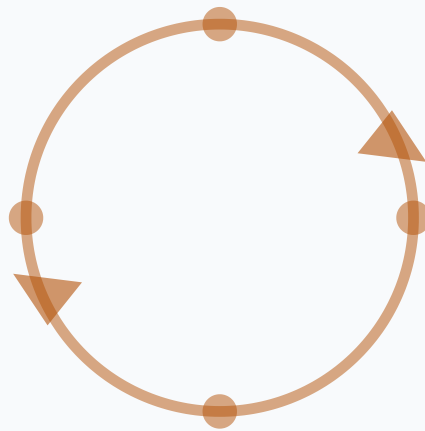
REFERENCE

Cohen, A.R. and Bradford, D.L. (2005) Influence Without Authority. 2nd edn. Hoboken, NJ: Wiley.

Tactical Empathy

A set of listening moves — labelling, mirroring, calibrated questions — that make the other side feel understood before any proposal is made.

Labelling, mirroring and calibrated questions



KEY POINTS

- Label the emotion you observe out loud
- Mirror the last three words to open them up
- Ask 'how' and 'what', never 'why'
- Understanding is not the same as agreeing

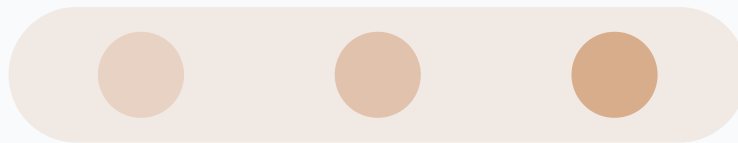
REFERENCE

Voss, C. (2016) Never Split the Difference: Negotiating As If Your Life Depended On It. New York: HarperBusiness.

Persuasion ↔ Manipulation Line

A boundary test asking whether an influence attempt engages the other party's capacity to reason or deliberately bypasses it.

Does the tactic engage reason or bypass it?



KEY POINTS

- Persuasion works through reasons they can inspect
- Manipulation works by hiding the mechanism
- Transparency test: could you disclose the tactic?
- Asymmetric information is the usual red flag

REFERENCE

Sunstein, C.R. (2016) The Ethics of Influence: Government in the Age of Behavioral Science. New York: Cambridge University Press.

Eisenhower Matrix

A 2×2 sorting tasks by urgency and importance, exposing how much time is lost to urgent work that is not important.

Urgency against importance, and where time leaks



KEY POINTS

- Important and urgent: do it now
- Important, not urgent: schedule it — the growth quadrant
- Urgent, not important: delegate or automate
- Neither: delete without guilt

REFERENCE

Covey, S.R. (1989) The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People. New York: Free Press.

Objectives & Key Results

A goal system pairing one qualitative objective with three to five measurable key results that prove it was achieved.

One objective, three to five measurable results



KEY POINTS

- Objective: qualitative, memorable, time-bound
- Key results: measurable, few, uncomfortable
- Set them publicly, score them honestly
- Works at personal scale, not only corporate

REFERENCE

Doerr, J. (2018) Measure What Matters. New York: Portfolio/Penguin.

The Rule of 3

A nested commitment device: three wins for today, this week, this month, this quarter and this year, each level framing the one below.

Three wins for today, the week, the month, the year



KEY POINTS

- Three is what you can hold without a list
- Daily wins ladder up to weekly wins
- Forces prioritisation at every horizon
- Outcomes, not tasks

REFERENCE

Meier, J.D. (2010) Getting Results the Agile Way: A Personal Results System for Work and Life. Bellevue, WA: Innovation Playhouse.

Monday Vision, Daily Wins, Friday Reflection

A weekly rhythm of planning three outcomes on Monday, naming a win each day, and reviewing what went well and what to improve on Friday.

Plan Monday, win daily, reflect Friday



KEY POINTS

- Monday: three outcomes for the week
- Daily: name the win before you start
- Friday: what went well, what to improve
- Plan, do, review as a weekly loop

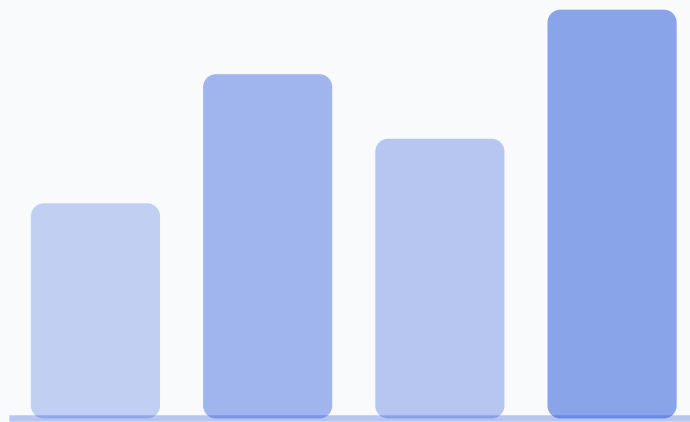
REFERENCE

Meier, J.D. (2010) Getting Results the Agile Way: A Personal Results System for Work and Life. Bellevue, WA: Innovation Playhouse.

Pareto 80/20

An empirical regularity in which a small share of inputs accounts for most of the output, used to locate the work that actually matters.

A small share of inputs produces most of the output



KEY POINTS

- Identify the vital few against the trivial many
- Applies to results, errors and time sinks alike
- Cut before you optimise
- Re-test the ratio; it drifts

REFERENCE

Koch, R. (1998) The 80/20 Principle: The Secret of Achieving More with Less. London: Nicholas Brealey.

Prompt Anatomy

A four-part prompt structure — role, task, context, format — that turns a vague request into a specification the model can meet.

Role, task, context, format as a specification



KEY POINTS

- Role: the expertise and stance to adopt
- Task: the single action required
- Context: constraints, audience, source material
- Format: length, structure, what to exclude

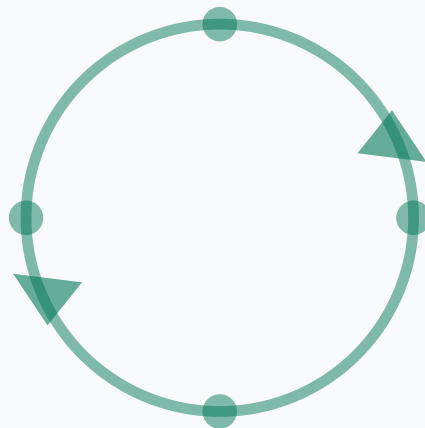
REFERENCE

White, J. et al. (2023) 'A prompt pattern catalog to enhance prompt engineering with ChatGPT', arXiv preprint arXiv:2302.11382.

Delegate–Verify–Own Loop

A working pattern in which AI produces a draft, the human verifies against a source, and the human retains accountability for the output.

AI drafts, you verify, you remain accountable



KEY POINTS

- Delegate the draft, not the decision
- Verify against a source you could cite
- Own the output publicly, errors included
- Verification effort scales with the stakes

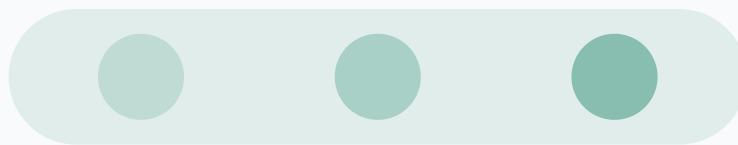
REFERENCE

Amershi, S. et al. (2019) 'Guidelines for human-AI interaction', Proceedings of the 2019 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems, pp. 1–13.

Automation–Augmentation Spectrum

A task-level continuum from AI replacing the work entirely to AI extending what a person can do, with most roles sitting in between.

From replacing the task to extending the person



KEY POINTS

- Analyse tasks, not whole jobs
- Automate the routine and the repeatable
- Augment where judgment carries the value
- The paradox: automating narrows future capability

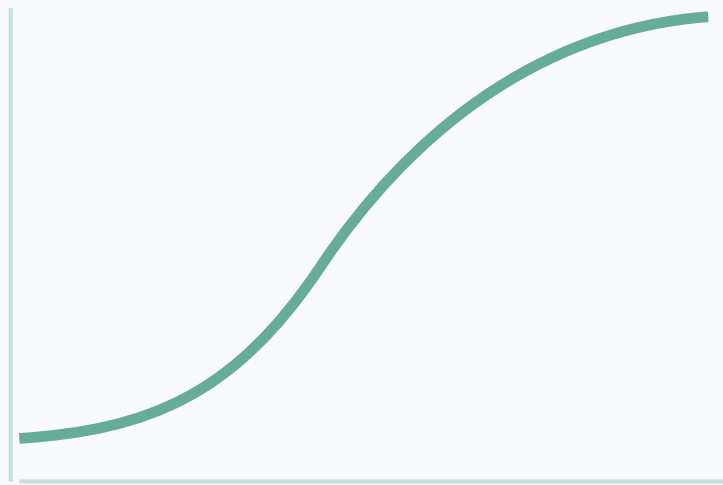
REFERENCE

Raisch, S. and Krakowski, S. (2021) 'Artificial intelligence and management: The automation-augmentation paradox', Academy of Management Review, 46(1), pp. 192–210.

The Jagged Frontier

A finding that AI capability is uneven and invisible from outside: tasks of similar apparent difficulty fall on opposite sides of what the model can do well.

Capability is uneven and the edge is invisible



KEY POINTS

- Inside the frontier: large performance gains
- Outside it: confident, plausible errors
- The boundary is not where intuition puts it
- Centaur splits tasks; cyborg interleaves them

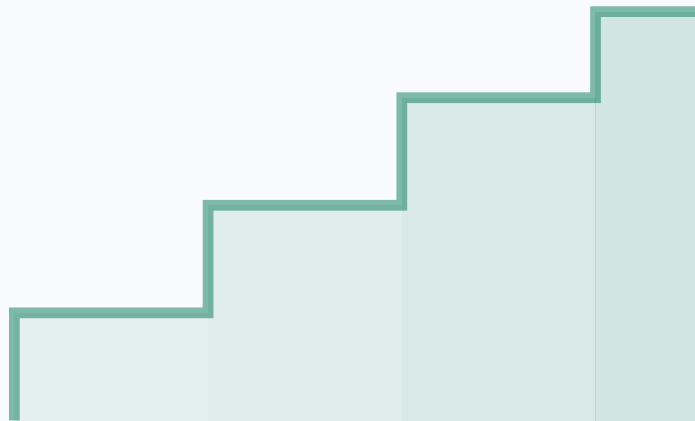
REFERENCE

Dell'Acqua, F. et al. (2023) 'Navigating the jagged technological frontier', Harvard Business School Working Paper 24-013.

AI Attribution Ladder

A disclosure scale running from no AI use, through assistance with drafting or editing, to substantive generation — each rung requiring a different declaration.

Disclosure rungs from no use to substantive generation



KEY POINTS

- Rung 1: no AI involvement
- Rung 2: language and formatting assistance
- Rung 3: structural or analytical contribution
- Rung 4: substantive generation — declare in full

REFERENCE

UNESCO (2023) Guidance for Generative AI in Education and Research. Paris: UNESCO.